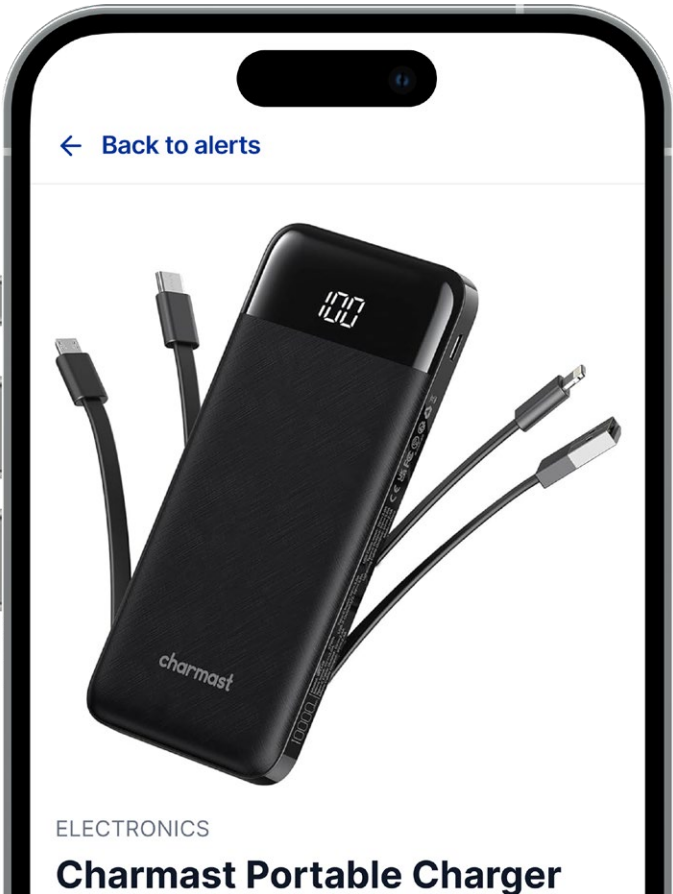
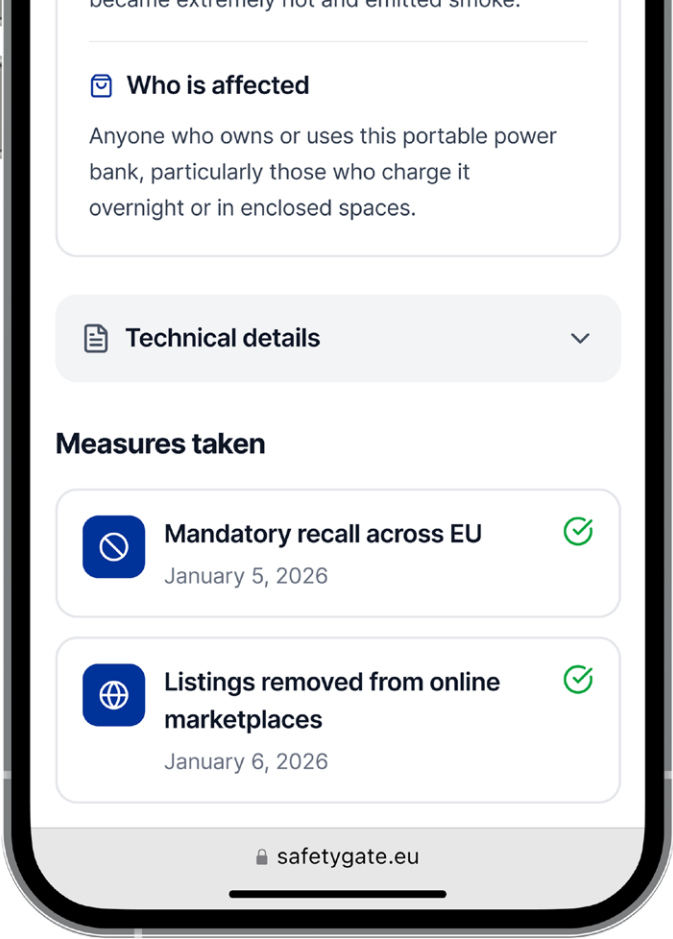
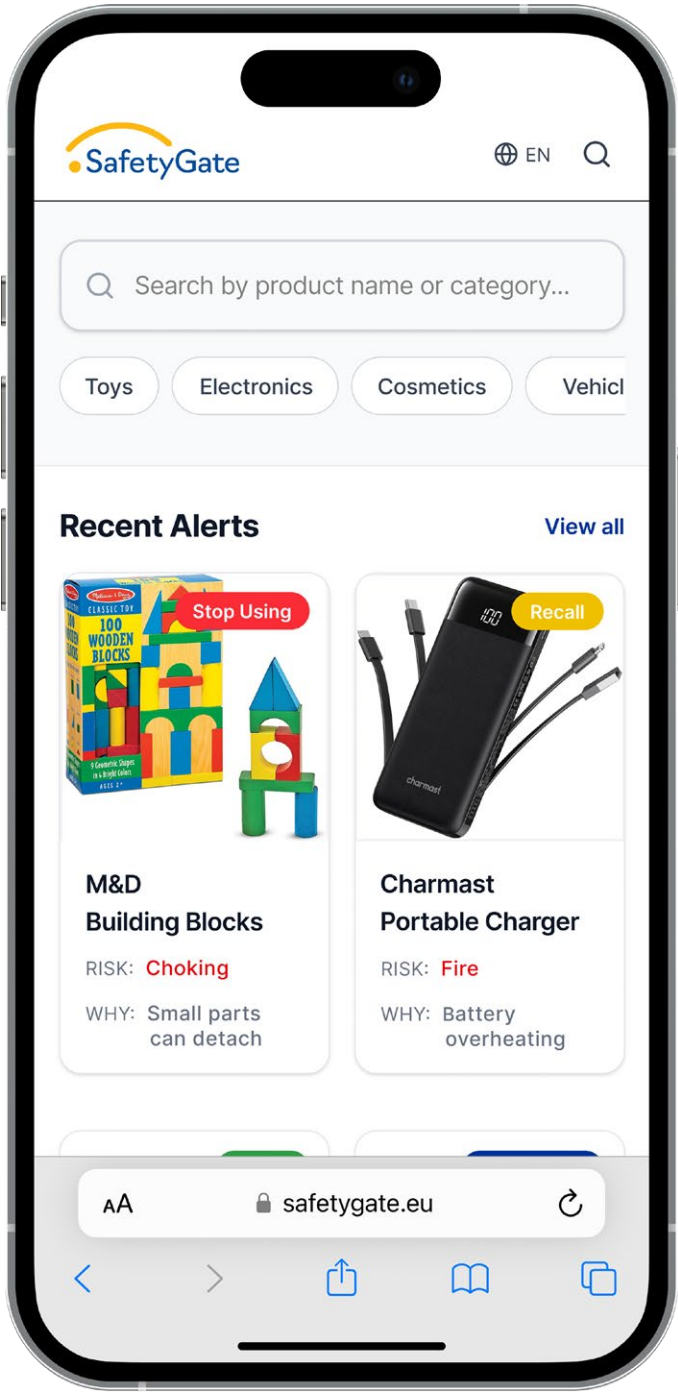




This project explores a service and platform redesign of the European Safety Gate, the EU-wide system used to report and communicate unsafe non-food products.

Developed in the context of the European Product Safety Week in Brussels, the project combines policy analysis, stakeholder research, and service design to reimagine how product safety information can become more understandable and consumer-centered.

Team project · 3 months

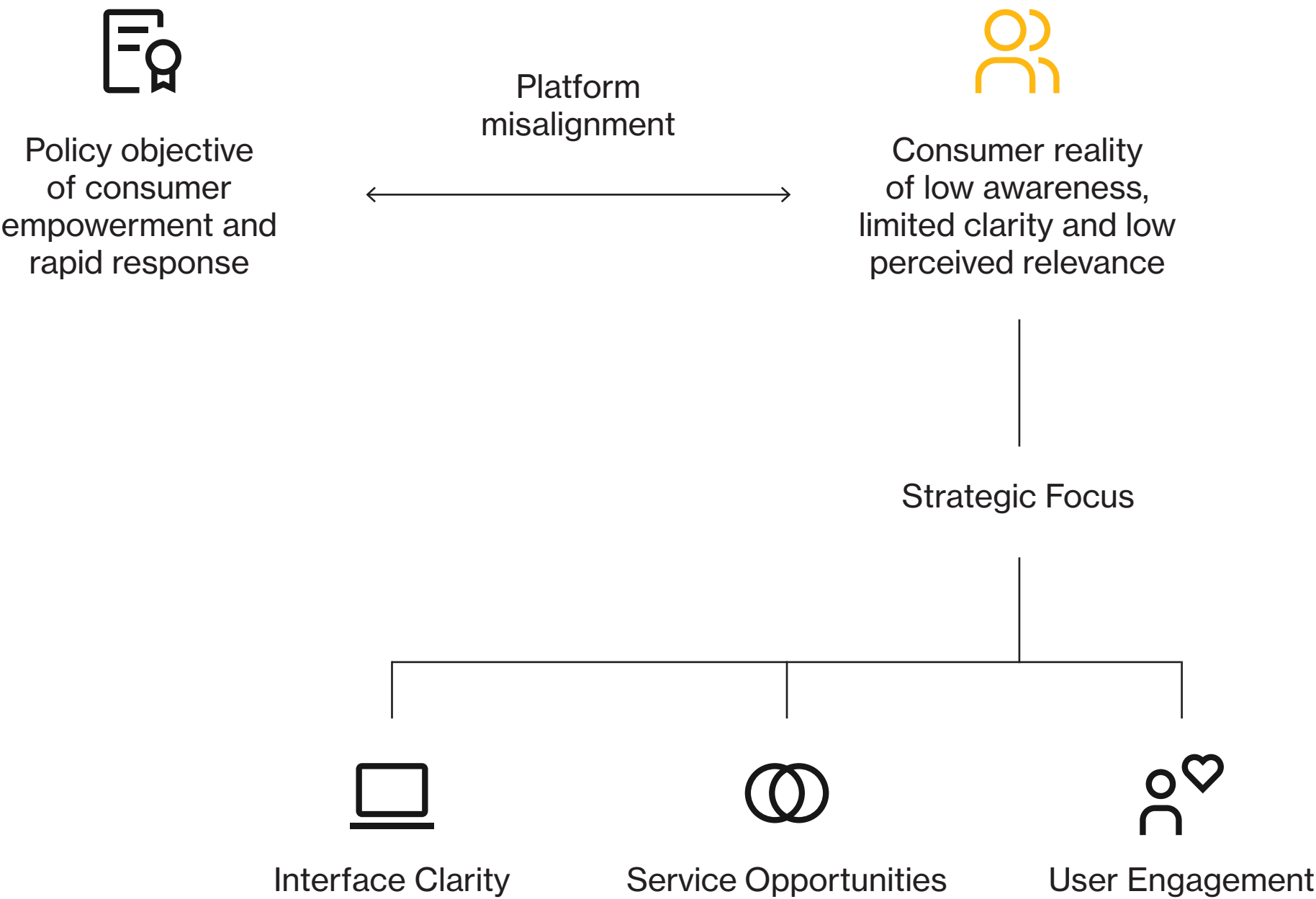


The European Safety Gate is a core pillar of the EU’s product safety framework, enabling rapid information exchange between national authorities and providing public access to safety alerts.

With the introduction of the General Product Safety Regulation (GPSR) in December 2024, the platform’s role expanded significantly: consumers gained new reporting channels, businesses faced stricter obligations, and online marketplaces became directly involved in enforcement.

This shift came with new tensions, making the Safety Gate a critical case for service and platform redesign.





The objective of the Safety Gate, as defined by the GPSR, is to empower consumers and enable rapid action when unsafe products are identified.

However, early analysis revealed a misalignment between this policy intent and the lived experience of consumers, which often perceived it as unclear, difficult to engage with, or largely unknown.

This gap framed the core brief of the project: to critically analyze the Safety Gate as a public-facing digital platform, identifying where design interventions could better align institutional goals with real user needs.

The analysis therefore focused on three key areas: improving interface clarity, identifying service-level opportunities beyond information disclosure, and strengthening user engagement to support meaningful consumer participation.

Research

Desk research on EU policy, Safety Gate documentation, and public reports established a baseline understanding of the system’s goals and regulatory constraints under the GPSR. However, this alone did not explain how the platform is actually perceived and used in practice by different actors.

Field research conducted during European Product Safety Week provided critical qualitative insight. Importantly, several participants also proposed concrete improvements based on their hands-on use of the system.

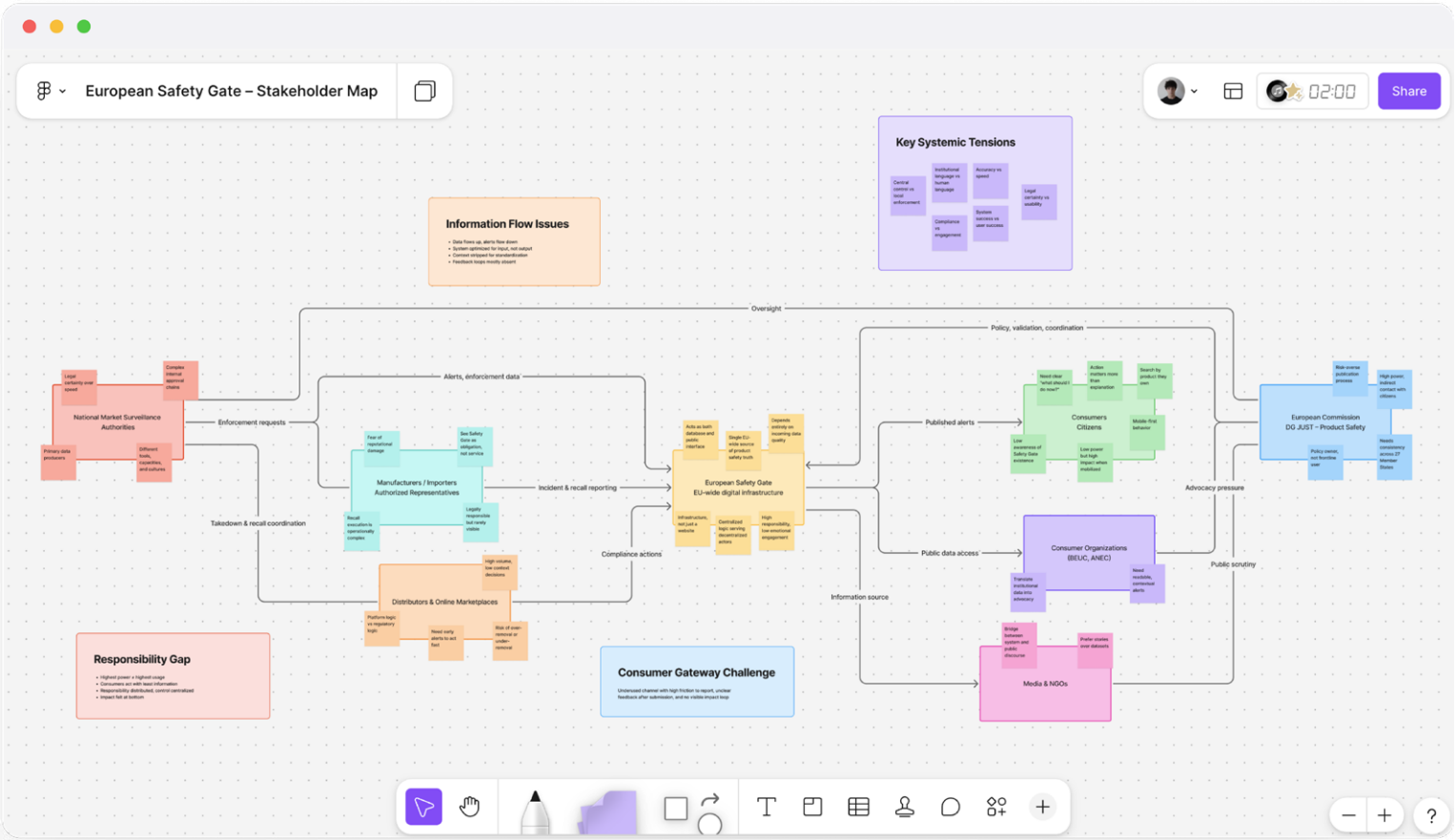
These perspectives were synthesized into a stakeholder map that clarified differences in expectations, priorities, and information needs across roles. Hearing directly from platform users helped identify what truly matters at each touchpoint and informed the core principles of the redesign, particularly around clarity, actionability, and role-sensitive presentation of information.



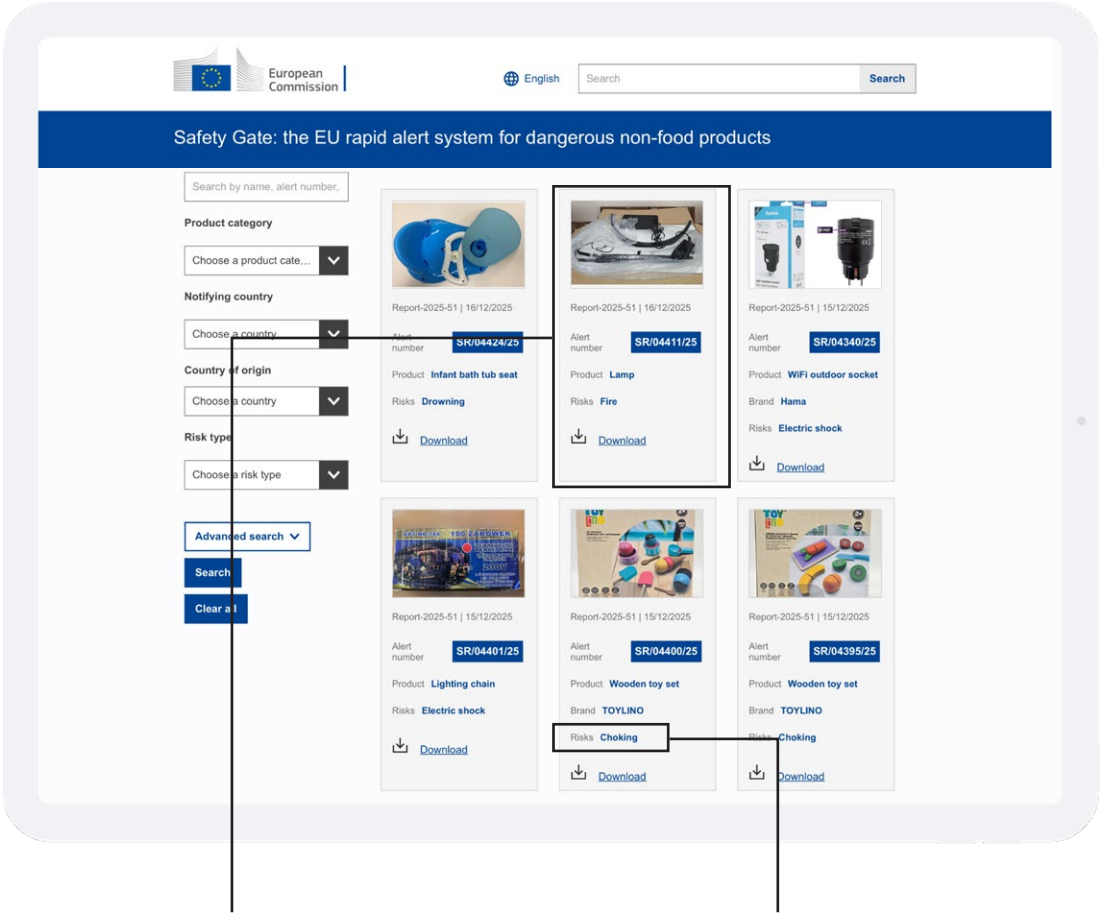
Understanding perspectives



Stakeholder Map



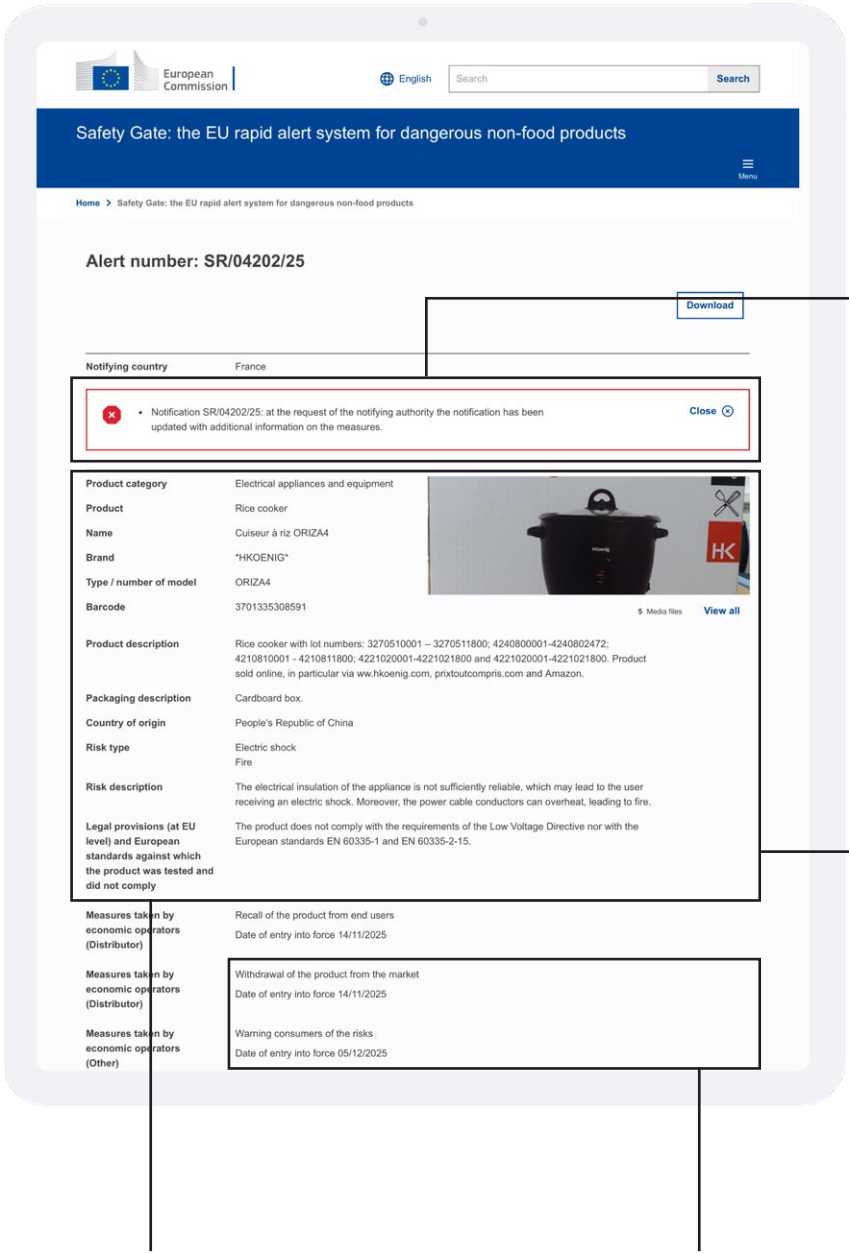
Heuristic Evaluation



Weak product
identifiability

Lack of risk
salience

Identifying usability gaps



Unclear system
feedback

Expert-centric
language

Flat information
hierarchy

Lack of
actionability

Building on user perspectives, a heuristic evaluation of the Safety Gate platform was conducted. The evaluation highlighted and confirmed several usability issues that make it difficult for users to quickly understand, interpret, and effectively use the tool, resulting in generalised public disengagement.

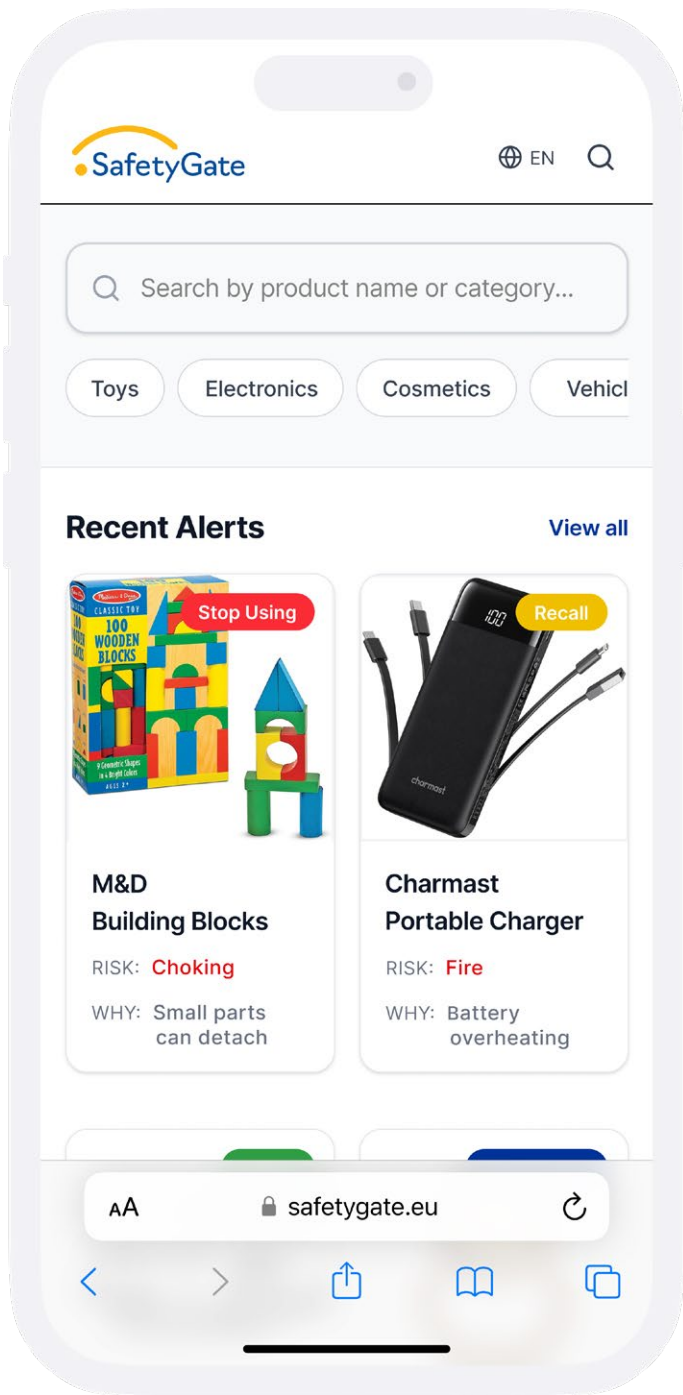
Translating qualitative stakeholder perceptions into concrete usability findings helped validate user suggestions and directly informed the core redesign principles.



The redesign repositions the Safety Gate platform around how safety information is actually encountered and used in everyday situations. The platform is conceived primarily for mobile browser use, acknowledging that alerts are mostly accessed in everyday contexts by consumers.

Information is reorganized to reduce cognitive load and support fast comprehension, placing emphasis on what the risk is, who is affected, and what action should be taken. Regulatory and technical details remain accessible but are visually and structurally secondary.

Beyond access to alerts, the redesign aims to strengthen consumer participation in product safety. The platform is conceived as a space for awareness and prevention, combining reporting with educational content and safety campaigns.

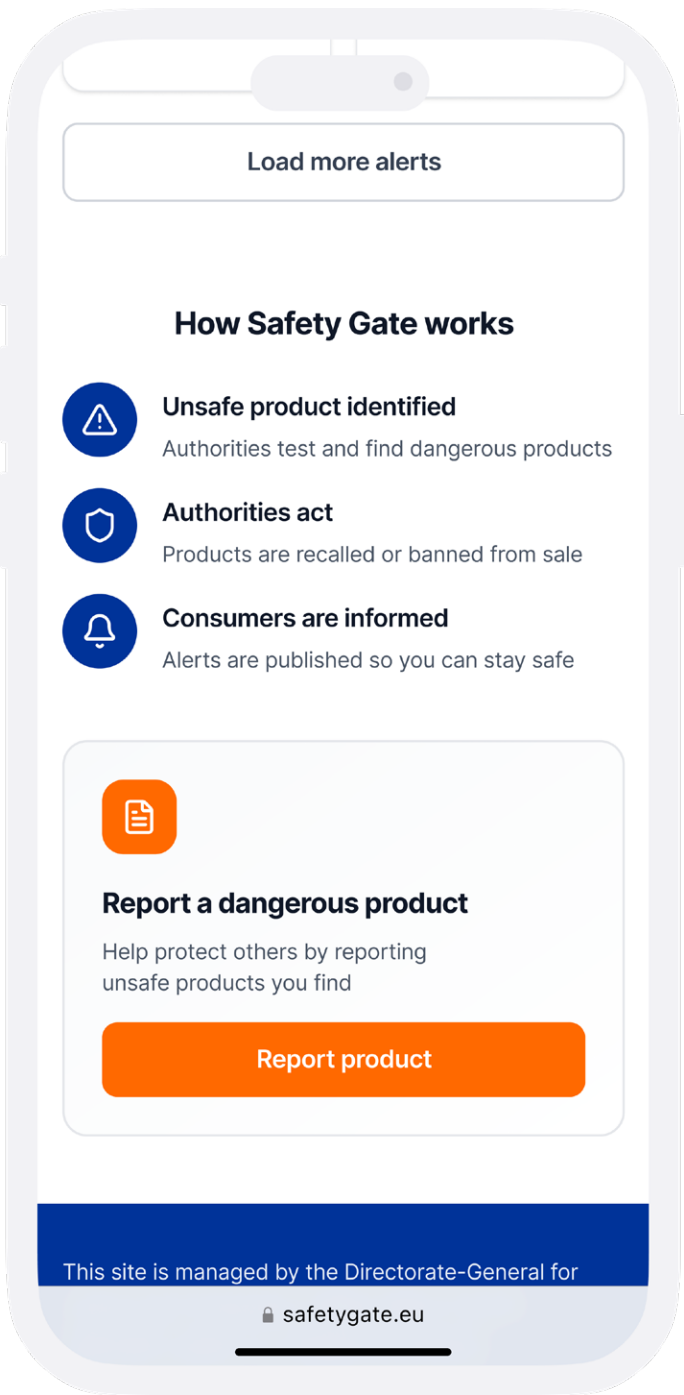


Search Bar

Single search bar that enables users to locate products, brands, or alerts, supported by quick category filters, improving findability across product sectors.

Alert Cards

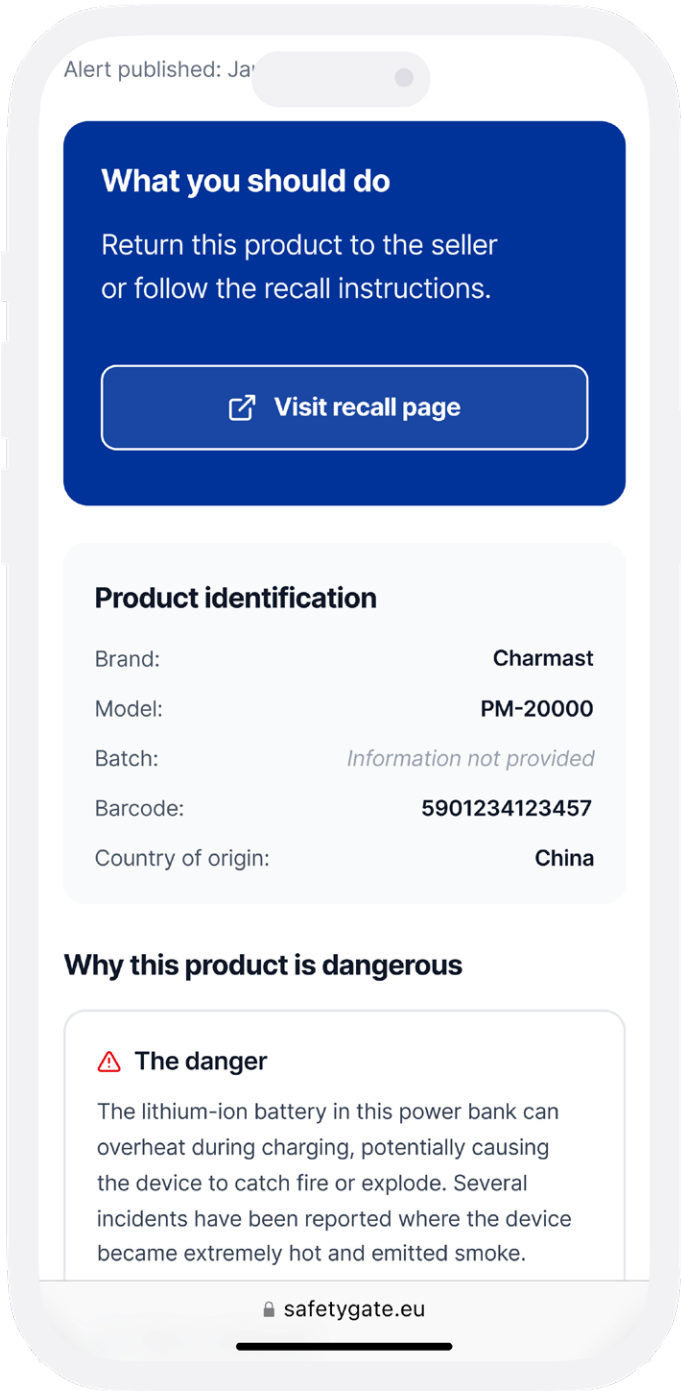
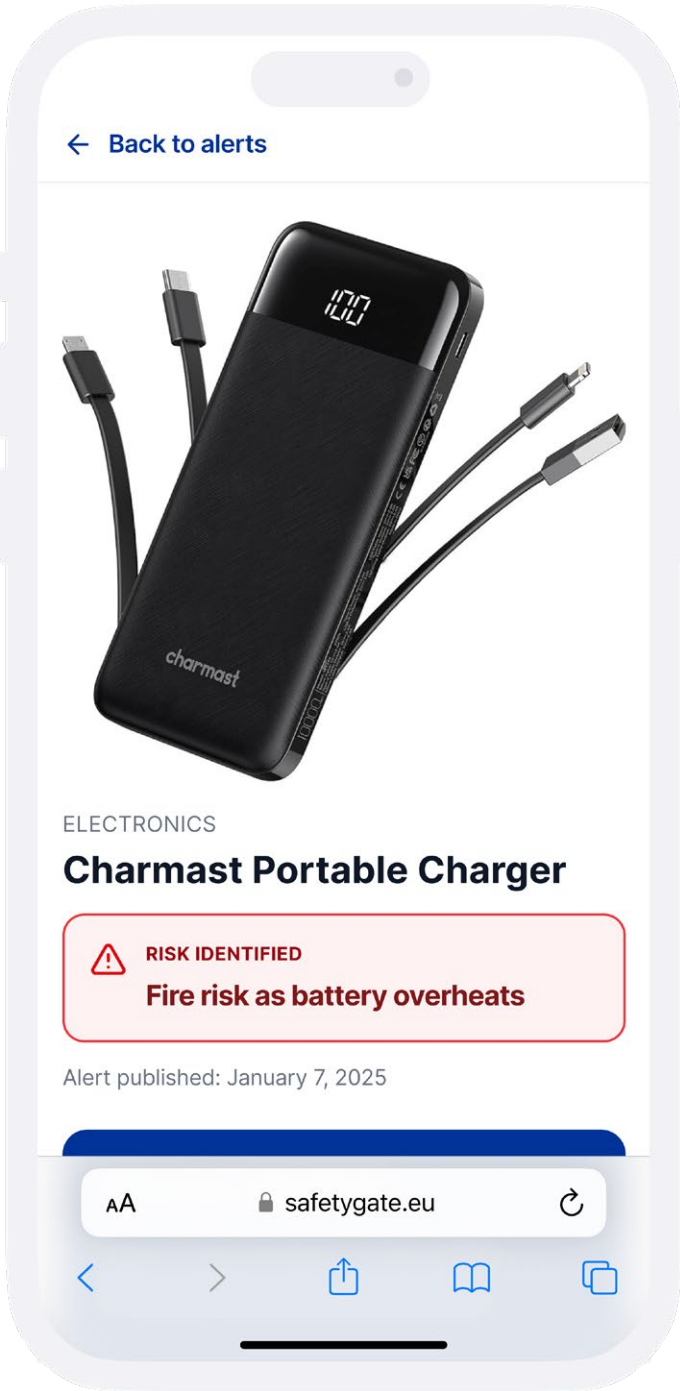
Structured overview of recent alerts displayed as cards, highlighting essential information and measures taken to support rapid understanding.



Product Report

A unified access point for consumers to submit reports on potentially unsafe products, with a brief explanation at the end of the page.

Currently, consumer reporting is handled through different national and regional authorities, resulting in inconsistent user experiences. This would therefore require a service-level redesign to coordinate flows and responsibilities.



Actionable Insights

Clear presentation of the measures advised for consumers, indicating how to respond to the alert.

Information Structure

A hierarchical layout that emphasizes information through visual prioritization, while secondary or technical details are organized in expandable sections.

